

World Café

What this tool produces · *A synthesized matrix of collective intelligence, cross-pollinated ideas, and shared visions generated from highly structured, rotational group discussions,.*

G2 · Proof of Fit

Dimensions

Social / User

Regulation

Preparing the workshop · *World Café*

G2 · Proof of Fit

Why this tool matters

Replacing the intimidating setup of a formal public hearing with the warmth of a coffee table, proving that profound political solutions often emerge from casual, horizontal conversations.

Evidence we produce

A synthesized matrix of collective intelligence, cross-pollinated ideas, and shared visions generated from highly structured, rotational group discussions,.

Duration & Material

Duration · 45 minutes to 3 hours

Material · Small tables, writable tablecloths, colored pens, facilitation guides

Reference case

The City of Greater Geraldton used World Cafés during its "Geraldton 2029" planning project. A group of forty trained community champions facilitated these sessions, where residents moved from table to table to have serious conversations about the city's future, operating on the assumption that locals already possess the wisdom and creativity to confront difficult challenges.

Suggested agenda · Brief (10 min) > Method walk-through (15 min) > Animation canvas (60-90 min) > Harvest (20 min)

Café tables × question rounds × harvest

Duration
45 minutes to 3 hours

What works today?

Table 1

Host stays · participants rotate every 20 min.

What is broken?

Table 2

Host stays · participants rotate every 20 min.

What if money was unlimited?

Table 3

Host stays · participants rotate every 20 min.

What would you do tomorrow?

Table 4

Host stays · participants rotate every 20 min.

Harvest round

Each host shares the strongest insights · the room votes the top 3.

Harvesting our *learnings*

After running the canvas, capture three layers of insight.

What inspires me

Stand-out signals, surprising stories, ideas to remember

How to apply it here

Concrete adaptations to our context, our team, our constraints

What we need to be autonomous

Skills, allies, resources, decisions still to secure

Each participant fills a copy. Then debrief together to surface patterns and next steps.